Luuk Schmitz

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Research interests

International Political Economy, geoeconomics, corporate power, industrial policy, economic planning

Academic Appointments and Fellowships

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam: Assistant professor of international political economy 2026-

Max Planck Institute for the Study of Societies: Senior researcher 2023-2026

Max Planck Institute for the Study of Societies: Visiting researcher Spring 2022

Radboud University: Junior Lecturer in Political Science and Economics 2018-19

Education

European University Institute: Ph.D. 2019-2023

Dissertation: After Market Making: The Political Economy of EU Industrial Policy

Radboud University: Political science, B.A. & M.A (*cum laude*) 2013-2018

Publications

Journal articles

2026 | The Costs of Conditionality. IPCEIs and the Constrained Politics of EU Industrial Policy (with T. Seidl and T. Wuttke). *Competition and Change 30*(2).

2025 |Picking Losers: Climate Change and Managed Decline in the European Union (With T. Ergen). *Regulation & Governance* (online first).

2024 | Moving on to not fall behind? Technological sovereignty and the 'geo-dirigiste' turn in EU industrial policy (With T. Seidl). *Journal of European Public Policy*, *31*(8), 2147–2174.

2023 | Europe first? The rise of EU industrial policy promoting and protecting the single market (With D. Di Carlo). *Journal of European Public Policy*, *30*(10), 2063–2096.

2023 | As Open as Possible, as Autonomous as Necessary: Understanding the Rise of Open Strategic Autonomy in EU Trade Policy (With T. Seidl). *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 61: 834–852.

2020 | From coherence to coheritization: explaining the rise of policy coherence in EU external policy (With T. Eimer). *Globalizations*, *17* (4), 629–647.

Book chapters

2020 | Power(ful) and Power(less): A Review of Power in the ESG–Agency Scholarship (With Andrea Gerlak *et al*), in: Michele M. Betsil, Tabitha M. Benney & Andrea Gerlak (eds): Agency in Earth Systems Governance, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Book project

Stacking Order: Technology and the Remaking of Global Interdependence. Book manuscript in preparation.

Working papers

2026 |Hierarchies of Adaptation. Corporate Power in Economic Statecraft. *OSF Preprint*.

2024 | A Primer for the use of Classifier and Generative Large Language Models in Social Science Research. (with J. Cova). *OSF Preprint*

2022 | Protecting, Transforming, and Projecting the Single Market. Open Strategic Autonomy and Digital Sovereignty in the EU's Trade and Digital Policies (With T. Seidl). *OSF Preprint*.

Work in progress

Planning the Tech-Industrial Complex: Sourcing-in, Crowding Out, and Power in the AI Stack (with L.Dagorne). *Under review*.

The Geopolitical Construction of Markets: Conversion, Enrollment, and Entrenchment. *Manuscript available upon request*.

Vertical Integration in the Electric Vehicle Revolution: Evidence from BYD, Tesla, Toyota, and Volkswagen (with P.Gerbaudo & G.Anzolin). *Manuscript available upon request*.

Exit, Coalitions, and Anomy: Business Politics under Geoeconomics. *Paper in progress*.

Patriots or Profiteurs? Corporate Agency in the EU's Geoeconomic Turn (with R.Bosticco). *Paper in progress*.

What Is Different About Chinese Automotive Capitalism? EV Industrial Stacks, Growth Model Pressures, and Geopolitical Steering. (with P.Polyak). *Paper in progress*.

When External Pressures Shift Domestic Coalitions: Industrial Policy Change in the Netherlands (with J.Simons). *Manuscript available upon request*.

Whose Strategic Autonomy? Ukraine and the EU's Critical Raw Materials Strategy (with D.Karas). *Manuscript available upon request*.

Policy Briefs

2026 | Industrial Policy Conditionality: A Guide for Users. *New Energy Industrial Policy Center*.

2024 | The Costs of Conditionality: Lessons from IPCEIs (with T. Seidl and T. Wuttke). Rome: *LUHNIP Policy Brief 2/2024*.

2015 | Central and Eastern European countries at the crossroads: Why governments should reject investment arbitration in TTIP (with C. Olivet). Amsterdam: *Transnational Institute*.

Media and other writings

2023 | Backlash. Article where my work on climate change and deindustrialization is discussed (in Dutch). *De Groene Amsterdammer*.

2023 | Opinion piece about EU industrial policy (in Dutch, with J.H. van Dijk). *NRC Handelsblad*.

2022 | Blog version of As open As Possible (with T. Seidl). *JCMS Ideas on Europe*.

2020 | Reflections on how COVID-19 is reshaping th EU's industrial strategy. *EUIdeas*.

Funding and Awards

JEPP Best paper prize 2024. Awarded for: Moving on to not fall behind? Technological sovereignty and the 'geo-dirigiste' turn in EU industrial policy (With T. Seidl). *Journal of European Public Policy*, *31*(8), 2147–2174.

Ph.D. Scholarship, *European University Institute & Nuffic* (fully funded), 2019-2023. €80.000.

Selected for best conference paper special issue (JEPP), European Union Studies Association, 2022. Awarded for: Europe first? The rise of EU industrial policy promoting and protecting the single market (With D. Di Carlo).

Teaching and Supervision

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Political Science

Global Political Economy, B.A.	Fall 2026
Selected Issues in Global Political Economy, M.A.	Fall 2026

University of Cologne, Political Science

European Political Economy, B.A.	Spring 2025

Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf, Political Science

The Internal and External dimensions of EU Economic Governance, B.A.	Spring 2025

Max Planck Institute for the Study of Societies

Natural Language Processing for Social Scientists	Spring 2026
Using Large Language Models (LLMs) in Social Science Research	Spring & Fall 2024

Radboud University, Political Science

Introduction to academic writing, B.A.	Fall 2018
Economics for political scientists, B.A.	Fall 2018
Introduction to linear regression analysis, B.A.	Spring 2019
The Politics of EU crisis management, M.A.	2018-2019
B.A. Thesis supervision (6 students)	Spring 2019

Teacher Training Certificate

Introduction to Teaching and Learning in Higher Education, European University Institute	Oct–Nov 2021

Talks and presentations

Invited Talks & Workshops

Sciences Po Paris, Center for European Studies, April 2027.

Maastricht University, EUROSUMMIT, February 2027.

Humboldt University, Age of Planning? Berlin, October 2026.

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, Department of political science (job talk), June 2026.

Hanover Symposium on Industrial Policy, Hanover, April 2026.

Columbia University, Center for Political Economy. New York, November 2025.

Sciences Po & MPIfG, 'Green backlash', Paris, May 2025.

Robert Schuman Centre for Advanced Studies, Political Economy Work Group, Florence, April 2025.

Villa Vigoni, 'Europe and the Geoeconomic Challenge', Loveno di Menaggio, April 2025.

Hertie School of Governance & Jacques Delors Centre, 'Getting EU Industrial Policy Right'. Berlin, September 2024.

European University Institute, 'European industrial policy & the new geopolitics of markets'. Florence, April 2023.

Conference Presentations (selection)

Council for European Studies: 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2026

Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics: 2021, 2022, 2024, 2025, 2026

European Union Studies Association: 2022

ECPR Standing Group on the European Union: 2022

European Workshop in International Studies: 2024, 2025

Netherlands Institute for Governance: 2025, 2026

Academic Service

Workshops and Conferences organized

'Markets, Hierarchies, or Platforms? Corporate Planning in the Age of Digitalization'. Joint DVPW–DGS Conference on Political Economy and Economic Sociology. Frankfurt, 18-19 March 2027 (with C.Sorg).

'The geoeconomic turn in international political economy', MPI for the Study of Societies, Cologne, 30-31 January 2025 (with P. Polyak).

Committee work

Co-convener of the European University Institute's Political Economy Work Group 2020-2023

Administrative roles

Research Data Management Adviser at the MPIfG Since 2026

Referee

American Journal of Sociology, Applied Economics Letters, Comparative Political Studies, Competition & Change, European Law Open, Finance & Society, German Politics, Global Political Economy, Governance, Integration, Journal of European Public Policy, Journal of Common Market Studies, Journal of European Integration, MPIfG

DP Series, New Political Economy, Politics and Governance, Regulation & Governance, Review of International Political Economy, Socio-Economic Review, The International Spectator, West European Politics.

Languages

Dutch (native), English (fluent), German (proficient), Italian (conversational), Spanish (aspirational)

Programming

Research methods and computational skills

Advanced: R, Quarto

Intermediate: Python, LaTeX

Software

Advanced: RStudio, Gephi, Claude Code

Intermediate: Visual Studio Code